

FOUR WEEKS · PARENTS ONLY

Do the course together. Hold the line together.

Phone License is built for one family at a table. This plan puts five or six of them in a living room while they do it — because a norm held by one family is a fight, and a norm held by six is just the rules.

HOW IT FITS THE COURSE

Families do the six-week course at home with their kid, on their own pace. The group meets four times — parents only — and covers the course in pairs of weeks. The group is where parents say the true thing they can't say in front of their kid. The course is where they say it to their kid.

THE RHYTHM

- Group 1** · Weeks 0–1 · The milestone
- Group 2** · Weeks 2–3 · What they're up against
- Group 3** · Weeks 4–5 · Safety and honesty
- Group 4** · Week 6 · The agreement and the night

EACH MEETING · 75 MINUTES

- 0:00** Food first. Fifteen minutes. Not optional.
- 0:15** Open — one question, everyone answers
- 0:25** Watch — one clip from the course, together
- 0:35** Discuss — five questions, thirty minutes
- 1:05** Do this week — the Road Test part, assigned
- 1:10** Close — a verse and a prayer, five minutes

GROUP SIZE

Four to six couples. Single parents welcome and needed. Kids' ages within a few years of each other — a 9 and a 15 are different conversations.

FOR THE FACILITATOR

You're a host, not a teacher. Six things.

01 Go first. Go honest.

Every question, you answer before anyone else — and your answer includes the embarrassing part. The room's honesty will never exceed yours.

02 Nobody fixes anybody.

When a parent confesses something hard, the only response is "thank you for saying that." Advice is for the parking lot, if they ask.

03 Coach, not cop — for you too.

Some families in your group will hold a softer line than you would. Your job is a room where they can tighten it, not a room where they're judged for where they started.

04 Phones in a basket at the door.

Yours too. It'll feel silly for four minutes. Then it'll be the reason the group works.

05 Protect the clip.

Ten minutes of the course, watched together, keeps everyone on the same page even when three families are behind. Never skip it to make time for talking.

06 End on the verse, not the debrief.

Read it, pray one sentence, stop. The group will linger — that's where the real conversations start.

IF SOMEONE SAYS SOMETHING SERIOUS

A kid in real danger — exploitation, self-harm, a predator. Don't process it in the group. Say "let's talk after," and connect them with your pastor or a counselor that night. The Emergency Rule applies to parents too.

Group 1

COURSE WEEKS 0-1 • ORIENTATION • RULES OF THE ROAD

The milestone nobody trained for.

OPEN

"How old were you when you got your first phone — and who taught you how to use it?"
Everyone. Thirty seconds each.

WATCH

Week 0, the opening — why a license and not a permission slip. About ten minutes. If the group hasn't started the course, this is the start.

DISCUSS

- 01 What's the fight in your house right now? Say the actual words that get said.
- 02 "Nobody taught them how to use it." Who taught you? How's that going for you?
- 03 Cars, marriages, guns — we license the powerful things. Why does licensing a phone feel strange?
- 04 Which of the Four Norms would cost your family the most? Which is already true?
- 05 What would change if the six families in this room held the same line?

DO THIS WEEK

Road Test, Parts 1–2: the passcode both parents know, Screen Time locked, downtime set. Bring the fight it caused to Group 2.

CLOSE

"Teach us to number our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom."

PSALM 90:12

Group 2

COURSE WEEKS 2-3 • DIGITAL FOOTPRINT • ATTENTION • NIGHT DRIVING

What they're actually up against.

OPEN

"What's the app that takes an hour you didn't mean to give?" Parents name their own. No kid talk yet.

WATCH

Week 3 — the attention trap. The slot machine section. About ten minutes.

DISCUSS

- 01 How did the Road Test go? What broke — the settings or the relationship?
- 02 "Free apps aren't free — you pay in attention." Where is your family paying the most?
- 03 The Three Filters: Grandma, Ten Years, Front Page. Which one would your kid fail first? Which would you?
- 04 Where do phones sleep in your house tonight — honestly? What would it take to move them?
- 05 What did you see in your kid this week that you'd have missed without paying attention?

DO THIS WEEK

Road Test, Parts 3–4: charging station outside every bedroom, non-human notifications off. Buy the ten-dollar alarm clock. Everyone's phone. Parents' too.

CLOSE

"'I have the right to do anything,' you say — but not everything is beneficial. 'I have the right to do anything' — but I will not be mastered by anything."

1 CORINTHIANS 6:12

Group 3

COURSE WEEKS 4-5 • IDENTITY • PEER PRESSURE • STRANGER DANGER 2.0

Safety and honesty.

OPEN

"What's something you're glad didn't exist online when you were fifteen?" Specific enough that it costs you something.

WATCH

Week 5 — the Rule of Three and the Emergency Rule. About ten minutes. This is the clip the group most needs to see together.

DISCUSS

- 01 Who does your kid follow that makes them feel worse? Do you know? How would you find out without it being an interrogation?
- 02 "The moment someone says 'don't tell your parents' is the moment you tell your parents." Would your kid? What would stop them?
- 03 The Emergency Rule — no punishment, no lecture, no shame. What's the hardest part of that promise for you to keep?
- 04 Read the Rule of Three aloud. Which of the three does your family talk about least?
- 05 If your kid came to you tonight with something terrible — what's the first sentence out of your mouth? Practice it. Now.

DO THIS WEEK

Road Test, Parts 5–6: content restrictions, location per-app, contacts reviewed together. Then read the Emergency Rule to your kid, out loud, from the card.

CLOSE

"Whoever conceals their sins does not prosper, but the one who confesses and renounces them finds mercy."

PROVERBS 28:13

Group 4

COURSE WEEK 6 • BEING PRESENT • THE AGREEMENT

The agreement, and the night.

OPEN

"When has your kid felt like they were competing with your phone?" Let it sit. Then: "Were they right?"

WATCH

Week 6 — being present. The sacred times. About ten minutes.

DISCUSS

- 01 Bring your draft Family Agreement. Read one line from Article III — the parents' promises — to the group. Which one will be hardest?
- 02 Article IV, consequences: read yours aloud. Is it a rule of the road, or a threat?
- 03 What's one line another family read tonight that you're stealing?
- 04 The Issuance Night is coming. Who in your family will cry? Who will say it's cringe? Both mean it's working.
- 05 Six weeks ago you named the fight. What's the fight now?

DO THIS WEEK

Finish Article V together. Road Test Part 7 — your kid shows you three settings unprompted. Then RSVP to the church's Issuance Night, or set your own Launch Dinner date.

CLOSE

"These commandments that I give you today are to be on your hearts. Impress them on your children. Talk about them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road."

DEUTERONOMY 6:6-7

Then: commit to meeting once more, ninety days from now, for the renewal. Same room, same food, the scorecards in hand.